12-Week 5K + Push / Pull / Legs (PPL) Hybrid Plan

Calibrated to 5K Goal **25:30–26:00 (5:10–5:12/km)** · 10K PB 56:22 · 5K PB 27:23 · VDOT 33.8 · Easy 6:50–7:40/km · Tempo 5:48–5:56/km · Interval 5:15–5:28/km · Matched to Hevy Equipment (Barbell, Dumbbell, Pull-up Bar).

Core Hybrid Rules (Avoiding the Interference Effect):
• **Isolate Legs from Upper Days:** Remove all squats/lunges/calf raises from Push and Pull days so Mon & Wed never fatigue legs before Tue Intervals or Thu Tempo.
• **72-Hour Recovery Window Before Speedwork:** Tuesday VO2max intervals (5:15–5:28/km) require 100% fresh legs. Keep Legs on Saturday (or Friday/Thu PM) for 72–96h recovery.
• **Spare the Lower Back on Wednesday:** Avoid heavy axial deadlifts on Pull day so your hamstrings and spinal erectors are fresh for Thursday's Tempo run.
• **Low-Rep, Low-Soreness Leg Training:** Train Legs heavy/low-rep (4–8 reps @ RPE 7.5–8, stopping 2 reps shy of failure). High-rep failure sets cause 48h DOMS that degrades running economy (m/beat).

1. Weekly Microcycle Options (Run + PPL Integration)

Day	5K Running Plan	Option A: Lift on Non-Run Days (Mon/Wed/Sat)	Option B: 'Hard Days Hard' (Best for Fast-Finish Wks)
Monday	Rest	**PUSH** (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps) — 0% leg fatigue before Tue	**PUSH** (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps)
Tuesday	**Quality Intervals** (400m–1000m @ 5:15–5:28/km)	Rest (Legs 72h fresh from Saturday)	Rest (Legs 96h fresh from Friday)
Wednesday	Rest	**PULL** (Lats, Upper Back, Biceps, Core) — spares lower back	**PULL** (Lats, Upper Back, Biceps, Core)
Thursday	**Tempo / Threshold** (15–30m @ 5:48–5:56/km)	Rest (Fresh posterior chain for Tempo)	Rest *(or LEGS 4–6h after Tempo)*
Friday	**Easy + Strides** (4–7 km Easy + 4–6×100m)	Rest	**LEGS** (After Easy run — gives 48h recovery before Sun)
Saturday	Rest	**LEGS** (Squat, RDL, Lunge, Calf — RPE ≤8, no failure)	**Full Rest Day** (100% fresh for Sunday Fast-Finish Long Run)
Sunday	**Long Run** (10–15 km; Wk 8 TT; Wk 12 Race)	Rest (Aerobic endurance on slightly pre-fatigued legs)	Rest

2. Runner-Specific Push / Pull / Legs Prescriptions (Hevy Templates)

DAY 1: PUSH — Chest, Shoulders, Triceps & Core (Monday · ~50–60 min · 18 Sets)	Sets × Reps	Target RPE	Runner Coaching Notes
1. **Bench Press (Barbell)**	**4 × 6–8**	RPE 8.0	Primary horizontal press; 2–3 min rest. Zero CNS spillover to legs.
2. **Incline Bench Press (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 8–10**	RPE 8.0	Upper pec & anterior delt hypertrophy; controlled 2s lowering.
3. **Overhead Press (Barbell)** *or* **Shoulder Press (DB)**	**3 × 8–10**	RPE 8.0	Perform seated or brace glutes/core tightly to avoid lumbar hyperextension.
4. **Lateral Raise (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 12–15**	RPE 8.5	Strict medial delt isolation; supports relaxed arm-swing mechanics.
5. **Triceps Extension (Dumbbell)** *or* **Skullcrusher (DB)**	**3 × 10–12**	RPE 8.5	Long-head triceps focus; keep elbows tucked.
6. **Plank** *or* **Dead Bug (Core)**	**2 × 45–60s**	RPE 7.5	Anti-extension trunk stability for upright running posture.

DAY 2: PULL — Lats, Upper Back, Biceps & Obliques (Wednesday · ~50–60 min · 17 Sets)	Sets × Reps	Target RPE	Runner Coaching Notes
1. **Pull Up**	**4 × 5–8**	RPE 8.0–8.5	Vertical pull staple; decompresses spine between Tuesday & Thursday runs.
2. **Bent Over Row (Barbell)** *(or 1-Arm DB Row Wks 7/10)*	**4 × 8–10**	RPE 8.0	Upper-back thickness; switch to supported DB row on 30-min tempo weeks.
3. **Shrug (Barbell)** *or* **Rear Delt Fly (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 12–15**	RPE 8.0	Prevents upper-back rounding in the final 1.5 km of a 5K race.
4. **Seated Incline Curl (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 10–12**	RPE 8.5	Long-head bicep stretch; zero axial fatigue.
5. **Hammer Curl (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 10–12**	RPE 8.5	Brachialis & forearm strength.
6. **Crunch (Weighted)** *or* **Side Bend (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 12–15**	RPE 8.0	Anti-rotation & anterior core stability for efficient stride transfer.

DAY 3: LEGS — Economy, Posterior Chain & Tendon Stiffness (Sat or Fri · ~45–55 min · 15 Sets)	Sets × Reps	Target RPE	Runner Coaching Notes
1. **Squat (Barbell)** *(after 1–2 Bodyweight/Bar warm-up sets)*	**4 × 5–6**	RPE 7.5–8.0	Low reps build maximal force & neuromuscular recruitment without high DOMS.
2. **Romanian Deadlift (Barbell)**	**3 × 6–8**	RPE 8.0	Eccentric hamstring resilience & hip-extension power for 5:10/km pace.
3. **Lunge (Dumbbell)** *or* **Goblet Squat**	**3 × 8 / leg**	RPE 8.0	Single-leg pelvic stability (fixes left/right ground-contact imbalance).
4. **Hip Thrust (Barbell/Dumbbell)** *or* **Glute Bridge**	**2 × 10–12**	RPE 8.0	Concentric glute drive with minimal eccentric muscle damage.
5. **Standing Calf Raise (Dumbbell)**	**3 × 12–15**	RPE 8.5	Slow 3s lowering + 1s pause; Achilles stiffness is #1 for 5K running economy.

3. Complete 12-Week Integrated 5K + PPL Master Schedule

Week-by-week synchronization of your 5K running workouts and PPL strength volume/intensity adjustments. km column includes warm-up/cooldown (3 km on Tue, 1.5 km each side on Thu).

Wk	Mon (Push)	Tue (Quality Run)	Wed (Pull)	Thu (Tempo Run)	Fri (Easy Run)	Sat (Legs)	Sun (Long Run)	km
1	Push 100% (18 sets, RPE 8)	6×400m @ 5:15–5:28, 90s jog	Pull 100% (17 sets, RPE 8)	15 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	5 km Easy + 4×100 strides	Legs 100% (15 sets, RPE 7.5)	10 km Easy	**27**
2	Push 100% (+reps or +1–2kg)	5×800m @ 5:15–5:28, 2min jog	Pull 100% (+reps or +1–2kg)	20 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	5.5 km Easy + 5×100 strides	Legs 100% (15 sets, RPE 8)	11 km Easy	**31**
3	Push 100% (Peak Base Vol)	6×600m @ 5:15–5:28, 2min jog	Pull 100% (Peak Base Vol)	3×10 min @ 5:48–5:56, 2min jog	6 km Easy + 5×100 strides	Legs 85% (12 sets) *or move to Fri*	12 km, last 2k @ 6:02–6:35	**33.5**
4 *Deload*	**Deload Push** (-30%: 3 sets/ex, RPE 7)	4×800m @ 5:15–5:28, 2min jog	**Deload Pull** (-30%: 3 sets/ex, RPE 7)	15 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	4.5 km Easy	**Deload Legs** (9–10 sets, RPE 7)	10 km Easy (benchmark)	**26.5**
5	Push 100% (Resume overload)	6×800m @ 5:15–5:28, 2min jog	Pull 100% (Resume overload)	3×1.5km @ 5:48–5:56, 90s jog	6 km Easy + 5×100 strides	Legs Maint. (12 sets) 3 sets/ex, RPE 8	13 km, last 3k @ 6:02–6:35	**36**
6	Push 100% (18 sets, RPE 8)	5×1000m @ 5:15–5:28, 2min jog	Pull 100% (17 sets, RPE 8)	25 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	6.5 km Easy + 6×100 strides	Legs Maint. (12 sets) 3 sets/ex, RPE 8	14 km Easy	**37**
7	Push 100% (18 sets, RPE 8)	6×800m @ 5:15–5:28, 90s jog	Pull (Use DB Row to spare low back)	30 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	7 km Easy + 6×100 strides	Legs Maint. (11 sets) *or move to Fri*	14 km, last 3k @ 6:02–6:35	**38.5**
8 *Retest*	Push Normal (15–16 sets, RPE 8)	4×400m @ 4:52–5:03, 90s jog	Pull Normal (15 sets, RPE 7.5)	15 min easy tempo (light)	4 km Easy + 4×100 strides	**REST (Skip Legs)** Save legs for 5K TT	**5K TIME TRIAL** (target <26:30)	**23**
9 *Peak*	Push 100% (18 sets, RPE 8)	5×1000m @ 5:15–5:28, 2min jog	Pull 100% (17 sets, RPE 8)	3×2km @ 5:48–5:56, 2min jog	6.5 km Easy + 6×100 strides	Legs Low-Rep (10 sets) 3×5 Squat, 3×6 RDL	15 km, finish @ 6:02–6:35	**40**
10 *Peak*	Push 100% (18 sets, RPE 8)	6×800m @ 5:15–5:28, 90s jog	Pull (Use DB Row to spare low back)	30 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	7 km Easy + 6×100 strides	Legs Low-Rep (10 sets) 3×5 Squat, 3×6 RDL	15 km, 3k @ 6:02–6:35	**39.5**
11 *Taper*	**Taper Push (-40%)** (2–3 sets/ex, RPE 7)	5×1km @ 5:10–5:15 (goal pace), 2m jog	**Taper Pull (-40%)** (2–3 sets/ex, RPE 7)	20 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	5.5 km Easy + 4×100 strides	**Light Legs (-50%)** (2 sets/ex, RPE 6.5)	12 km Easy	**33**
12 *Race*	**Light Push** (2 sets/ex, RPE 6.5)	3×400m @ 5:10–5:15, 90s jog	**Light Pull** (2 sets/ex, RPE 6.5)	10 min tempo @ 5:48–5:56	3 km Easy + 4×100 strides	**FULL REST** (No lifting Thu–Sat)	**5K RACE** (Goal 25:30–26:00)	**21**

4. Garmin + Hevy Autoregulation Guardrails

Telemetry Signal (Garmin / Hevy)	Threshold	Actionable PPL Adjustment
Morning Body Battery / Sleep Score	Body Battery < 50 *or* Sleep < 6.5h	Keep Tuesday/Thursday run as priority; trim 1 working set per exercise in the gym and cap RPE at 7.5.
Overnight RHR & HRV Status	RHR +4 bpm above baseline	Finish evening gym sessions before 17:30 whenever possible; skip failure sets on accessory lifts.
48h Post-Leg Running Economy	Tuesday HR > +5 bpm at 5:20/km	Switch from Option A (Saturday Legs) to Option B (Friday Legs) or cut Squat/RDL from 4 sets to 3 sets.